

Defense Brief

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NATO Ankara Summit Opens Amid €140B Ukraine Pledge, KNDS IPO Collapse Signals Defense Investor Jitters

The Bottom Line

The NATO Ankara summit opens July 7 with the alliance preparing its largest multi-year Ukraine commitment — €140 billion over two years — alongside a formal designation of Russia as a threat to Euro-Atlantic security. But the gap between political ambition and industrial capacity is widening: KNDS's IPO postponement shows that even as governments promise more spending, investors aren't yet convinced defence companies can execute. Deputy SACEUR Stringer says European allies have 'largely' replaced US-cut NATO assets, but the qualifier matters — carrier strike groups and aerial refuelling cannot be replaced like-for-like. Meanwhile, China's low-cost stealth coating research and South Korea's supply chain positioning reveal two different models for closing the manufacturing gap: one through radical cost reduction, the other through proven platforms at volume. The Ankara summit will reveal whether NATO's political commitments can be matched by its industrial base.